

C208

Change Management and Innovation

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A 400-employee insurer rolled out a new claims workflow in March, with strong launch-day attendance and catered training. By September most adjusters were back to the old spreadsheets, and the old spreadsheet templates are still on the shared drive. Performance reviews still measure the old metrics. Which step of Lewin's model was neglected?

- A. None; strong launch attendance proves the change succeeded.
- B. Refreezing.
- C. Changing.
- D. Unfreezing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Before a hospital changes its shift schedule, leaders share data showing nurse overtime has doubled and patient falls have risen. Which Lewin step does this action serve?

- A. Adjourning.
- B. Changing.
- C. Refreezing.
- D. Unfreezing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A regional bank's CIO, recently hired from a large tech firm, plans to announce a new core banking system next month and start mandatory training right away. Staff believe the current system works fine. The vendor contract is worth \$8 million. Using Kotter's model, what should come first?

- A. Renegotiate the vendor contract.
- B. Build a sense of urgency by showing why the current system puts the bank at risk.
- C. Celebrate short-term wins.
- D. Begin mandatory training immediately.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

Warehouse supervisors are resisting a new scheduling system because they were not consulted and believe it ignores how shifts actually work. They have strong ties to the union and the warehouse was recently repainted. The supervisors understand the system well. What is the best first tactic?

- A. Participation: involve supervisors in adjusting the design.
- B. Coercion: require use and discipline refusals.
- C. Education: explain the system again in more detail.
- D. Negotiate with the union on wages.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A hospital system wants physicians to adopt a new clinical decision tool. It has 1,000 physicians, a new parking garage, and a strong brand in the region. A few respected, forward-looking physicians are well connected with peers. Whom should the rollout target first?

- A. All 1,000 physicians at once with a mandate.
- B. Only the innovators, since they are most eager.
- C. The laggards, to overcome the toughest resistance first.
- D. The respected early adopters who influence peers.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Using the standard diffusion curve, what share of a population has adopted an innovation by the time the late majority begins to adopt?

- A. 34%
- B. 50%
- C. 16%
- D. 84%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A startup launches a simple, low-cost ultrasound device that is less capable than hospital machines but is affordable for small rural clinics that could not buy one before. The founders have PhDs and raised \$20 million. Hospitals ignore it. What type of innovation is this?

- A. Radical innovation because it is high-tech and well funded.
- B. Not an innovation, since it performs worse than hospital machines.
- C. Disruptive innovation.
- D. Sustaining innovation.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A leading phone maker adds a sharper camera and longer battery life to its flagship model for its current premium buyers. What kind of innovation is this?

- A. Exploration.
- B. Disruptive innovation.
- C. Sustaining innovation.
- D. Process innovation.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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9.

A plant manager wants to move to lean production. Driving forces include cost pressure and a new CEO. Restraining forces include fear of job loss and a lack of training. The plant was built in 1985 and is the county's largest employer. Which approach is most likely to move the change with the least backlash?

- A. Increase driving forces by announcing tighter cost targets.
- B. Relocate the plant to a newer building.
- C. Wait for the restraining forces to disappear on their own.
- D. Reduce restraining forces, such as offering training and job-security commitments.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In a force field analysis, driving forces are rated at a total of 14 and restraining forces at 17. What must happen for the change to move forward?

- A.** Shift the balance by more than 3 points, ideally by weakening restraining forces.
- B.** Nothing; 14 is enough since it is over half of 31.
- C.** Raise restraining forces to 20.
- D.** Shift the balance by 31 points.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

During a merger, a division head holds listening sessions, shares a clear picture of what the combined company can achieve, challenges her team to rethink old processes, and mentors each manager on their new role. She drives a hybrid car and holds meetings on Mondays. Which leadership approach is she using?

- A.** Transformational leadership.
- B.** Laissez-faire leadership.
- C.** Autocratic leadership.
- D.** Transactional leadership.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A consumer-goods company set up a small unit to test subscription products. After two quarters, the CFO wants to shut it down because it misses the 18% margin target used for the core detergent line. The unit sits in a renovated downtown loft. What is the best response?

- A.** Move it to cheaper office space.
- B.** Shut it down; every unit must hit 18% margin.
- C.** Judge it on learning milestones suited to exploration, separate from core-line margins.
- D.** Merge it into the detergent line to cut costs.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A 400-employee insurer rolled out a new claims workflow in March, ~~with strong launch day attendance and catered training~~. By September most adjusters were back to the old spreadsheets, and the old spreadsheet templates are still on the shared drive. Performance reviews still measure the old metrics. Which step of Lewin's model was neglected?

Target word: missing step **Decides:** People reverted; systems and rewards still support the old way.

A	Camouflage	Launch attendance does not decide whether the change stuck.
B	Correct	The new workflow was never anchored in metrics, tools, and norms, so behavior slid back.
C	Confusion set	The change happened; it was not sustained.
D	Confusion set	Adoption at launch shows readiness existed; the failure came after the change.

2. Answer D Concept 1 · transfer

Before a hospital changes its shift schedule, leaders share data showing nurse overtime has doubled and patient falls have risen. Which Lewin step does this action serve?

Target word: step for a readiness action **Decides:** Showing why the current state cannot continue.

A	Confusion set	A team-development stage, not a Lewin step.
B	Adjacent category	No new behavior has been introduced yet.
C	Inverted operation	Refreezing locks in a new state after the change; this comes before it.
D	Correct	Creating dissatisfaction with the status quo prepares people to change.

3. Answer B Concept 2

A regional bank's CIO, ~~recently hired from a large tech firm~~, plans to announce a new core banking system next month and start mandatory training right away. Staff believe the current system works fine. ~~The vendor contract is worth \$8 million~~. Using Kotter's model, what should come first?

Target word: first step **Decides:** Staff see no reason to change.

A	Camouflage	The price does not decide the change sequence.
B	Correct	Kotter's first step is urgency; without it later steps stall.
C	Inverted operation	A later step; there are no wins yet.
D	Dropped element	Skips urgency, coalition, and vision.

4. Answer A Concept 3

Warehouse supervisors are resisting a new scheduling system because they were not consulted and believe it ignores how shifts actually work. They have strong ties to the union and ~~the warehouse was recently repainted.~~ The supervisors understand the system well. What is the best first tactic?

Target word: tactic matched to cause **Decides:** Resistance comes from lack of voice by people with real expertise.

A	Correct	When resisters have knowledge and were left out, involvement builds commitment and improves the plan.
B	Absolute language	Forcing compliance is a last resort and deepens resistance.
C	Adjacent category	They already understand it; information is not the gap.
D	Camouflage	Reacts to the union detail; pay is not the stated concern.

5. Answer D Concept 4

A hospital system wants physicians to adopt a new clinical decision tool. It has 1,000 physicians, ~~a new parking garage, and a strong brand in the region.~~ A few respected, forward-looking physicians are well connected with peers. Whom should the rollout target first?

Target word: whom to recruit first **Decides:** Early adopters are respected opinion leaders who spread adoption.

A	Absolute language	Ignores how innovations actually spread through a social system.
B	Adjacent category	Innovators are often seen as outliers; early adopters carry more peer influence.
C	Inverted operation	Laggards adopt last; targeting them first stalls diffusion.
D	Correct	Early adopters carry credibility to the early majority.

6. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

Using the standard diffusion curve, what share of a population has adopted an innovation by the time the late majority begins to adopt?

Target word: cumulative adoption **Decides:** Innovators + early adopters + early majority.

A	Wrong stem number	The size of one segment, not the cumulative total.
B	Correct	$2.5\% + 13.5\% + 34\% = 50\%$.
C	Dropped element	Innovators + early adopters only; leaves out the early majority.
D	Inverted operation	Adds the late majority, which is the point after it adopts.

7. Answer C Concept 5

A startup launches a simple, low-cost ultrasound device that is less capable than hospital machines but is affordable for small rural clinics that could not buy one before. ~~The founders have PhDs and raised \$20 million.~~ Hospitals ignore it. What type of innovation is this?

Target word: classify the innovation **Decides:** Simpler, cheaper, serving customers the incumbents overlook.

A	Camouflage	Funding and credentials do not define disruption.
B	Absolute language	Disruptive products often start as “worse” on mainstream measures.
C	Correct	It enters at a new/low-end market with a simpler product incumbents dismiss.
D	Confusion set	Sustaining improves products for existing mainstream customers.

8. Answer C Concept 5 · transfer

A leading phone maker adds a sharper camera and longer battery life to its flagship model for its current premium buyers. What kind of innovation is this?

Target word: classify an incumbent's upgrade **Decides:** Better performance for existing mainstream customers.

A	Confusion set	Refining the current product is exploitation.
B	Inverted operation	Disruption starts cheaper and simpler for overlooked customers, the reverse of this.
C	Correct	Improving the product along dimensions current customers value is sustaining.
D	Adjacent category	Process innovation changes how things are made, not the product itself.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A plant manager wants to move to lean production. Driving forces include cost pressure and a new CEO. Restraining forces include fear of job loss and a lack of training. ~~The plant was built in 1985 and is the county's largest employer.~~ Which approach is most likely to move the change with the least backlash?

Target word: which force to act on **Decides:** Reducing restraining forces lowers tension.

A	Inverted operation	Pushing harder raises tension and resistance.
B	Camouflage	The building's age is not a force in this change.
C	Dropped element	Drops any action; nothing changes the balance.
D	Correct	Weakening the forces against change moves the balance with less resistance.

10. Answer A Concept 6 · transfer

In a force field analysis, driving forces are rated at a total of 14 and restraining forces at 17. What must happen for the change to move forward?

Target word: condition for change **Decides:** Driving must exceed restraining; the gap is 3.

A	Correct	$17 - 14 = 3$; the balance must tip past that gap for change to proceed.
B	Wrong stem number	$14 / 31$ is 45%, and the question is which side is larger, not a share.
C	Inverted operation	That widens the gap against change.
D	Wrong stem number	The sum of both sides, not the gap.

11. Answer A Concept 7

During a merger, a division head holds listening sessions, shares a clear picture of what the combined company can achieve, challenges her team to rethink old processes, and mentors each manager on their new role. ~~She drives a hybrid car and holds meetings on Mondays.~~ Which leadership approach is she using?

Target word: name the approach **Decides:** Vision, intellectual stimulation, and individual consideration.

A	Correct	Vision, challenge, and personal development are its core behaviors.
B	Inverted operation	Laissez-faire is hands-off, the opposite of her involvement.
C	Adjacent category	She invites input rather than dictating.
D	Confusion set	Transactional exchanges rewards for meeting set standards.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A consumer-goods company set up a small unit to test subscription products. After two quarters, the CFO wants to shut it down because it misses the 18% margin target used for the core detergent line. ~~The unit sits in a renovated downtown loft.~~ What is the best response?

Target word: how to judge an exploratory unit **Decides:** Exploration should not be held to core-business metrics.

A	Camouflage	The office does not decide how to evaluate the unit.
B	Absolute language	Applying core metrics kills new ventures before they can learn.
C	Correct	Ambidextrous firms protect exploratory units from exploitation metrics.
D	Inverted operation	Folding exploration into the core subjects it to exploitation pressures.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	5	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Lewin's three-step model	Unfreeze (create readiness by showing why the status quo must go), change (move to new behaviors), refreeze (lock in the new state through systems, rewards, and norms).	Skipping refreeze, so people drift back to old habits.	People reverting to the old way months after a successful launch.
2	Kotter's sequence starts with urgency	Kotter's eight steps begin with a sense of urgency and a guiding coalition before vision, communication, and wins; skipping early steps undermines later ones.	Launching training or a new system before people see why change is needed.	A change announced with no shared case for why now.
3	Reducing resistance	Match the tactic to the cause: education for misinformation, participation for people who could design or block it, facilitation for fear or stress, negotiation for real losses; coercion is a last resort with high costs.	Treating all resistance as stubbornness to be overridden.	The reason the group is resisting (lack of information, lack of voice, real loss).
4	Diffusion of innovations	Adopters spread across innovators (2.5%), early adopters (13.5%), early majority (34%), late majority (34%), and laggards (16%); early adopters are respected opinion leaders who carry the change to the majority.	Targeting laggards or the whole population first.	A question about whom to recruit first to spread a change.
5	Disruptive vs. sustaining innovation	Sustaining innovation improves products for existing mainstream customers; disruptive innovation starts simpler and cheaper, serves overlooked or low-end customers, and moves upmarket over time.	Calling any breakthrough or high-tech product disruptive.	Whether the entrant starts at the low end/new market or improves the best product for top customers.
6	Force field analysis	Change happens when driving forces outweigh restraining forces; reducing restraining forces usually moves change with less backlash than adding pressure.	Only pushing harder on driving forces, which raises tension and resistance.	A list of forces for and against a change.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
7	Transformational leadership in change	Transformational leaders drive change through a compelling vision, role modeling, intellectual stimulation, and individual consideration; transactional leaders manage through rewards and corrections for meeting set standards.	Labeling a bonus-for-targets approach as transformational.	Whether the leader inspires and develops people or exchanges rewards for compliance.
8	Exploration vs. exploitation (ambidexterity)	Exploitation refines current products for efficiency; exploration searches for new options; ambidextrous firms protect exploration from the core business's metrics.	Judging an exploratory unit by the core business's short-term profit targets.	A new venture held to the same quarterly metrics as the established line.

Course scope (public description): This course provides an overview of change theories and innovation practices. This course will emphasize the role of leadership in influencing and managing change in response to challenges and opportunities facing organizations.